

How Do I Backup My Linux PC?

Linux's power is obviously in its command line, with tools like cron, rsync and tar providing the building blocks for a robust backup system. Cron is a system daemon that can be used to schedule any tasks to run automatically, rsync is a file-copying tool that speeds up file transfers by only copying parts of files that have been modified, and tar is tool (similar to WinZip) that is used to compress files into archives. While you can certainly get the job done by playing around with these command line tools, there are plenty of GUI options available that wrap around these tools with an easy point-and-click interface, sparing you from having to use the Command Line.

To demonstrate how to use such a tool, we've picked an example called LuckyBackup (more on this program later) to walk you through the process of setting up your backups and restoring files in the event of data loss.

1. Installation

LuckyBackup can be found in the repositories of Ubuntu, Fedora, Debian, Arch, OpenSUSE, Redhat, CentOS and even Windows. Ubuntu and Debian users can run the command

- `sudo apt-get install luckybackup`

to install it, while those using the yum package management tool (such as Fedora or Redhat) can use the command

- `sudo yum install luckybackup.`

Needless to say, you'll need sudo (administrator) access to use any of these commands. Once it's installed, you can start the program from your distro's Application Menu > System.

2. Configuring your first backup

LuckyBackup lets you create separate profiles, so you can separate the backup up of say, your photos from your important documents or system files. Individual profiles can be run on different schedules or can be backed up to different destination folders.

To start, you'll need to create your first profile by clicking on the 'Add' button in the right column.